

"Are You Safe?" — Workshop Summary

What is Rasekh?

Rasekh (راسخ) means *firmly rooted*. It is a women-led tech education initiative built for girls who were told tech isn't for them. Pakistan's tech sector is growing but women are left behind — Rasekh exists to change that, through education, community, and the belief that financial independence through tech is not a dream, it's a plan.

Mission: Equip Muslim women with tech skills, digital safety awareness, and the confidence to lead in a digital world.

Why This Workshop?

Most safety workshops just say "be careful online." This one goes deeper — explaining *why* the internet can be dangerous, *who* profits from your vulnerability, and *how* you can protect yourself and the people around you.

What is Cyberwarfare?

The internet was originally built by the US military. Today, the battlefield has moved from land to screens. Cyberwarfare means using digital attacks to destroy infrastructure, steal information, or control narratives — without firing a single bullet. It targets power grids, banks, hospitals, elections, and ordinary people.

The Two Big Real-World Examples

Stuxnet (2010) — The US and Israel built a worm that physically destroyed Iran's nuclear centrifuges using only a USB drive and software. No bombs. No soldiers. Just code. It was the world's first cyberweapon to cause real physical destruction. The lesson: digital attacks have real-world consequences.

Midnight Blizzard (2023–24) — Russian hackers got into Microsoft — one of the world's most powerful tech companies — through one old account that had no 2FA. They read senior executive emails for months before anyone noticed. The lesson: one unlocked door is all it takes, no matter how big the target.

Tech, Power, and Palestine

This is not conspiracy theory — it is documented fact:

Google and Amazon won a **\$1.2 billion contract** (Project Nimbus) to provide cloud and AI services to the Israeli military. Hundreds of Google employees protested and some were fired. The contract continued.

In Gaza, investigative journalists at +972 Magazine reported in 2024 that Israel used an AI system called "**Lavender**" to generate targeting lists with minimal human oversight. Data is the raw material of these systems.

Human Rights Watch has documented the suppression of Palestinian content on major social media platforms. Information is a battlefield — and we don't control the platforms.

Cyber Harassment — What It Is and Why It Matters

Cyber harassment means using digital platforms to intimidate, threaten, stalk, humiliate, or exploit someone. For women and girls it looks like: unwanted messages, fake accounts, image-based blackmail, doxxing, coordinated trolling, and stalking through location data.

Most women in Pakistan never report it — because they're blamed, because they're afraid, or because they don't know it's a crime. It is. **PECA 2016** (Pakistan's Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act) criminalises online harassment.

Muslims and the Information War

Beyond individual harassment, there is a larger pattern: algorithms designed to amplify division, state-sponsored disinformation campaigns targeting Muslim communities, and surveillance tools — like **Pegasus spyware** (built by Israeli firm NSO Group) — found on the phones of journalists and activists across Pakistan, India, and Saudi Arabia.

Digital literacy is no longer optional. It is a form of self-defence for our entire community.

How to Protect Yourself — The Essentials

- Use strong, unique passwords — never your name or date of birth
- Enable 2FA on every account, especially email

- Use a separate email for social media
- Turn off location sharing for apps that don't need it
- Never connect to free public WiFi without a VPN
- Don't click suspicious links — even from people you know
- If harassed: **screenshot first, then block and report**
- Never engage with trolls — it makes it worse

If Your Instagram Gets Hacked

Check your email for a security alert → click "Revert this change" → use "Forgot password" → if that fails, use "Need more help?" for identity verification → secure your email too → once back in, turn on 2FA immediately.

What Rasekh Teaches

Three tracks, all beginner-friendly, all built for women with zero prior experience:

Web Development — Build websites. HTML, CSS, JavaScript, GitHub. Foundation of the internet.

Programming — Python, Java, data structures, intro to AI. The language of the future.

Cyber Security — Kali Linux, cryptography, digital forensics, OSINT, WiFi security. The most urgent and in-demand skill in tech today.

A web developer in Pakistan can freelance for **\$500–\$2,000/month**. A cybersecurity professional internationally earns **\$80,000–\$150,000/year**. You don't need a degree. You need consistency and a community.

The Closing Thought

The internet was built without us. The algorithms were trained without us. The policies were written without us.

That changes when we're in the room.

Every woman who learns these skills is one more person who can protect her community, build for her community, and speak for her community in rooms where decisions are being made.

You asked: are you safe? Not yet. But you're here. And that's where it starts.